

Friday, 26 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

35° 24°

BIRMINGHAM

Rain

33° 22°

MANCHESTER

Rain

34° 21°

GLASGOW

Rain

26° 16°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 UK braced for hottest June night after 36.7C high on warmest day of year.**
Temperatures reach 36.7C in Merryfield, Somerset, the highest temperature so far this year and the hottest June day on record.
UK · NEWS
- 2 TikTok influencer charged with Dubai murder.**
Influencer Brooke George, 23, from Kent, claims she acted in self defence in stabbing her partner.
UK · NEWS
- 3 Burnham could be leader in weeks under Labour timetable.**
Andy Burnham could take over from Keir Starmer by 17 July, if he continues to be the only Labour MP in the race.
POLITICS · UK
- 4 Number of children getting special educational needs support hits another record high.**
It is the highest yearly increase in education, health and care plans (EHCPs) since they were introduced.
UK · NEWS
- 5 Obesity cases rising fastest in young adults.**
Experts say the cost of living, pandemic and boom in unhealthy food are behind the rise in cases.
UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Woman recalls posing for Freud after £25m art sale.**
Sue Tilley remembers champagne lunches and Freud's "scruffy" studio with a Rodin used as a doorstep.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Public invited to pay tribute to David Hockney.**
A book of condolence opens to allow people to pay tribute to David Hockney at Bradford City Hall.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Top Australian TV star to leave job after Tommy Robinson interview, reports say.**
Karl Stefanovic has helmed a popular breakfast TV show for the better part of two decades.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Club made famous by The Smiths gets listed upgrade.**
The 123-year-old club has helped generations of boys, and later girls, with sport, art and music.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Backstage at Gorillaz' epic, one-off stadium show: 'The vibe is ridiculous'.**
Damon Albarn, De La Soul and Moonchild Sannelly talk backstage as Gorillaz play their biggest show.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 The games that show the flaws in a 48-team World Cup.**
Two matches in the final round of group games present the chance for two teams to simply play out a draw to qualify.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Why it's time for Saka and Rashford - Shearer.**
Former England captain Alan Shearer explains why Thomas Tuchel needs to change some personnel as well as his team's mindset when they face Panama.
SPORT · UK
- 3 NFL's Arnold 'primary conspirator' in alleged kidnapping.**
Detroit Lions cornerback Terrion Arnold is arrested in Tampa, Florida, in connection with an alleged kidnapping and armed robbery.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Stay or go home? Tartan Army in limbo as Scotland await fate.**
BBC Scotland examines options for the Tartan Army in Miami as Scotland wait to discover if their World Cup adventure will continue or not.
SPORT · UK
- 5 Bellamy to stay with Wales as Burnley move off.**
Wales manager Craig Bellamy's proposed move to take charge at Championship side Burnley has fallen through.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners across the UK are finding creative ways to attract more wildlife to their outdoor spaces.**
From 'bug hotels' to 'nectar bars' for bees, a new survey highlights a growing passion for eco-friendly gardening practices, making our back gardens buzzing hubs of biodiversity.
- 2 The humble 'packed lunch' is getting a gourmet makeover, with more people opting for homemade, healthy, and exciting midday meals.**
Forget the soggy sandwich! Food enthusiasts are sharing colourful recipes and clever tricks for elevating the office or school lunchbox into a culinary delight.
- 3 A new trend sees people embracing the simple joy of 'stargazing', turning dark nights into magical celestial shows.**
With apps to identify constellations and local astronomy groups offering guidance, more Brits are looking up and discovering the wonders of the night sky.
- 4 The art of 'upcycling old furniture' is experiencing a renewed popularity, giving pre-loved pieces a new lease of life.**
Instead of buying new, people are transforming forgotten items with a lick of paint, new fabric, or clever customisations, making their homes uniquely stylish and sustainable.
- 5 Experts are suggesting that indulging in 'mindful walking' could be the key to boosting both physical and mental well-being.**
Taking time to notice your surroundings, feel the fresh air, and appreciate nature's small details can turn a simple stroll into a powerful stress-reliever.
- 6 The charm of 'vintage board games' is seeing a delightful resurgence, bringing families together for unplugged fun.**
From classic chess to retro parlour games, parents are introducing their children to the joys of face-to-face competition and laughter away from screens.
- 7 More people are discovering the soothing benefits of 'aquarium keeping', turning their homes into tranquil underwater worlds.**
Watching colourful fish glide through decorated tanks is proving to be a calming hobby, offering a peaceful escape from daily stresses.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're in a public toilet, even if there's no one else around?

ANSWER: HAVING A LITTLE CHAT OR EVEN SINGING A TUNE TO OURSELVES!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'item of clothing' that we absolutely refuse to throw away, even though it's seen better days?

ANSWER: A 'LUCKY' OLD T-SHIRT OR A 'COMFY' PAIR OF WORN-OUT SLIPPERS!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those little 'comfort foods' that instantly make us feel better, don't we?**
What's your go-to dish or snack that always brings a smile to your face and a feeling of warmth, no matter what?
- **You know how sometimes you pick up a 'new skill' or 'hobby' later in life and wonder why you didn't start sooner?**
What's something you've learned recently that has brought you unexpected joy or a sense of accomplishment?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Before pencils, Romans used styluses made of lead to write on wax tablets.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first public telephone box in the UK was painted bright pink, not red, to attract attention.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£9.52 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£9.52 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 stopped at Pudding Lane where it started, thanks to a change in wind direction.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The world's oldest known recipe is for beer, dating back to ancient Mesopotamia.
- Flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat, particularly brine shrimp.
- The British monarch technically owns all the unmarked swans in open water in England and Wales.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A group of ferrets is called a 'business'.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.

On this day

Day 177 of the year, 188 days left in 2026. Today Day of the Armed Forces of Azerbaijan; Christian feast day: Anthelm of Belley; Christian feast day: David the Dendrite; Christian feast day: Blessed Giacinto Longhin. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1993 — Ariana Grande, American singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress
- 1992 — Jennette McCurdy, American actress and singer-songwriter
- 1975 — Terry Skiverton, English footballer and manager
- 1984 — Aubrey Plaza, American actress
- 1970 — Sean Hayes, American actor
- 1909 — Colonel Tom Parker, Dutch-American talent manager, manager and promoter of Elvis Presley (died 1997)
- 1990 — Iman Shumpert, American basketball player
- 1955 — Mick Jones, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1960 — The former British Protectorate of British Somaliland gains its independence as Somaliland.
- 2007 — Pope Benedict XVI reinstates the traditional laws of papal election in which a successful candidate must receive two-thirds of the votes.
- 1997 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules that the Communications Decency Act violates the First Amendment to the United States Constitution.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2007 — Pope Benedict XVI reinstates the traditional laws of papal election in which a successful candidate must receive two-thirds of the votes.
- 1988 — The first crash of an Airbus A320 occurs when Air France Flight 296Q crashes at Mulhouse–Habsheim Airfield in Habsheim, France, during an air show, killing three of the 136 people on board.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2024 — Julian Assange, founder of WikiLeaks, returns to Australia after pleading guilty to one charge of espionage in a Saipan court and subsequently being released by the United States Department of Justice.

- 2000 — The Human Genome Project announces the completion of a "rough draft" sequence.
- 2015 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules, 5–4, that same-sex couples have a constitutional right to marriage under the 14th Amendment to the United States Constitution.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 178 of the year, 187 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Arialdo; Christian feast day: Crescens, one of the Seventy disciples; Christian feast day: Cyril of Alexandria (Coptic Church, Roman Catholic Church, Anglican Communion and Lutheran Church); Christian feast day: Hemma of Gurk. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Matthew Lewis, English actor
- 1936 — Shirley Anne Field, English actress (died 2023)
- 1924 — Bob Appleyard, English cricketer and businessman (died 2015)
- 1974 — Christian Kane, American singer-songwriter and actor
- 1975 — Tobey Maguire, American actor
- 1959 — Lorrie Morgan, American singer
- 1960 — Jeremy Swift, English actor
- 1942 — Danny Schechter, American director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2015)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1995 — Space Shuttle Atlantis launches on STS-71, the first space shuttle mission to dock with the Russian space station Mir.
- 1977 — France grants independence to Djibouti.
- 2024 — U.S. President Joe Biden debates former U.S. President Donald Trump. Biden's perceived poor performance leads to his withdrawal from the election on July 21.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1988 — Villa Tunari massacre: Bolivian anti-narcotics police kill nine to 12 and injure over a hundred protesting coca-growing peasants.
- 1954 — The Obninsk Nuclear Power Plant, the Soviet Union's first nuclear power station, opens in Obninsk, near Moscow.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)